THE TANK — PITCH REPORT

EcoPack

Funding Ask: 750000 for 10% equity

PROBLEM STATEMENT

E-commerce packaging waste is exploding, and most "biodegradable" alternatives are too expensive for small sellers to adopt.

SOLUTION

A subscription service supplying small online retailers with compostable mailers and boxes made from agricultural waste, priced at parity with plastic.

REVENUE MODEL

B2B subscription boxes sold in bulk tiers, plus a co-branded sustainability badge sellers can show customers.

TARGET AUDIENCE

Small to mid-size DTC e-commerce brands shipping 500-50,000 packages a month.

SCORECARD

Market Potential	**62/100**
Innovation	**58/100**
Business Model	**55/100**
Execution	**60/100**
Investment Worthiness	**54/100**
Overall	**58/100**

FINAL DECISION: COME BACK LATER

Valuation: — Funding: $0 Equity: —

PANEL REASONING

There's a real kernel of an idea here, but the panel wants to see traction, sharper unit economics, and a tighter go-to-market plan before committing capital.

Q&A TRANSCRIPT

Marcus Cole (Venture Capitalist): How big is the total addressable market here, and what's your path past your first city or niche?

Answer: “Shark, in India there are over 2 million e-commerce sellers, and around 5–6 lakh of them ship at scale. These brands spend ¹50,000 to ¹3 lakh per month on packaging, making our total addre
annually.”

“We’re starting with small to mid-size DTC brands in one city to prove unit economics. Once validated, we’ll expand city by city, then into Tier-2 and Tier-3 markets, and finally larger enterprise sellers.”

Marcus Cole (Venture Capitalist): What stops a well-funded competitor from copying this in six months?

Answer: “Shark, the hard part here isn’t the idea, it’s execution. We’ve built long-term contracts with agricultural-waste suppliers and local manufacturers, which takes time and trust to replicate.”

“Our cost parity with plastic comes from optimized sourcing, scale purchasing, and subscription predictability — not something a competitor can match overnight.”

“We also lock in customers through recurring subscriptions, custom packaging specs, and a sustainability badge that’s tied to their brand."

Priya Anand (Serial Founder): What have you actually built so far, and what's stopped you from getting it in front of real customers today?

Answer: “Shark, we’ve already built and tested compostable mailers and boxes using agricultural waste, and we’ve validated durability, cost, and compliance with pilot manufacturers.”

“We also have the subscription pricing model and supply chain mapped out, including supplier MOUs.”

“What’s held us back from full rollout is working capital — packaging needs upfront manufacturing and inventory before revenue comes in.”

Priya Anand (Serial Founder): What's your single biggest execution risk over the next 12 months?

Answer: “Shark, our biggest execution risk over the next 12 months is managing supply chain scale while maintaining cost parity with plastic.”

“Sustainable packaging needs upfront inventory and consistent raw material quality, which puts pressure on working capital.”

“We’re mitigating this by locking supplier contracts early, running subscription-based demand forecasting, and scaling city by city instead of all at once.”

Dana Reyes (Everyday Customer): Why would I switch from what I'm using today to this?

Answer: “Shark, you’d switch because we give you sustainable packaging at near-plastic pricing without changing your workflow.”

“We handle sourcing, quality, and compliance, so brands don’t have to manage multiple vendors.”

“Our subscription model ensures predictable supply and pricing, which most suppliers don’t offer.”

“On top of that, brands get a clear sustainability badge they can show customers and regulators.”

“So it’s not just greener — it’s simpler, predictable, and brand-positive.”

Dana Reyes (Everyday Customer): What happens the first time your product lets me down — do I come back?

Answer: “Shark, if we ever let you down, we take the hit — not the customer.”

“We have replacement and credit guarantees built into our contracts, so your shipments don’t stop.”

“Because packaging is mission-critical, we maintain buffer inventory and backup manufacturing partners.”

“Most importantly, our relationship is subscription-based — if we fail once and don’t fix it fast, we lose the customer, so retention is everything for us.”

Walter Sinclair (Angel Investor): Walk me through your unit economics — what does it cost you to acquire and serve one customer?

Answer: “Shark, it costs us about ^{1}8,000–^{1}10,000 to acquire one DTC brand cust
referrals.”
“Once onboarded, our average customer generates ^{1}1.2–^{1}1.5 lakh in annual rever
“Serving the customer includes manufacturing, logistics, and support, which is fully covered within that margin.”
“Because this is a subscription model, payback happens within 2–3 months, and lifetime value is over 6–8× CAC.”

Walter Sinclair (Angel Investor): When do you actually turn a profit, and what happens to my money if you don't hit that?

Answer: “Shark, we expect to turn contribution-level profitable within 12 months and company-level profitable in 18–24 months as volumes scale.”
“Your money is primarily used to lock supply, fund initial inventory, and acquire customers — not for experimentation.”
“If profitability takes longer, capital efficiency protects your downside: subscriptions give us predictable cash flow and inventory turns quickly.”
“Worst case, the assets — supplier contracts, inventory, and customer base — retain value